

Kerry Houghton Autopsy

Initial Assessment,

The body suffered violent puncture wounds on the hands and above the collarbone, presumably made by the bloody chisels and screwdrivers placed on a nearby tray. Pliers and a garden mattock are also among the murder weapons. Her teeth were removed. The head of the mattock was used to pry her lower jaw off. The pressure of this procedure was, presumably, what caused the victim's eyeballs to burst.

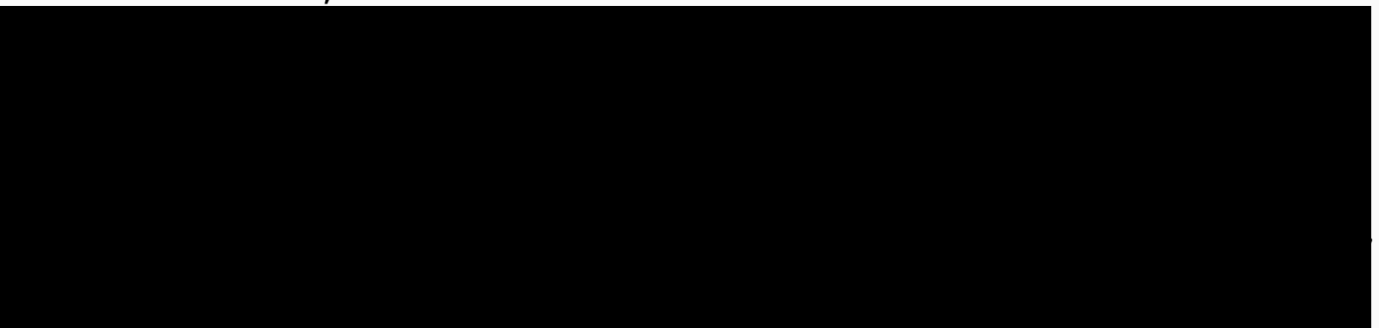
Houghton died from a combination of shock and suffocation on her own blood. The lividity of bruising on the temples and torso indicate she was likely beaten and dragged against her will from a separate location. Faint scrapes on the tops of her toes indicate she was dragged to the sitting position against the building before being pinned to the garage door of the warehouse. She was pinned using chisels and screwdrivers: a flathead through the left wrist, a Phillips through the right hand, and a chisel through the left shoulder. The force required to do this while the victim struggled suggests multiple assailants.

The broken nose, missing hair, and bruising on the brow indicate Houghton's head was held back after she was pinned. Then her teeth were removed. It's at this point the victim began to aspirate on her own blood.

The process would have been extremely loud, and the lack of response fits the time of death and isolated location. The back molars were more broken off than pulled. To get the rest of the teeth, the killers used the mattock to sever the jaw ligaments and separate the jaw while Houghton was still alive. The rip in the flesh between the second and third right metacarpals likely occurred as the victim struggled against this final attack.

It's unclear how long Houghton survived. Cardiac arrest could have occurred shortly after the removal of her jaw. Or asphyxiation may have come quickly as blood poured down the windpipe and into the lungs while the victim tried to scream. The strength required for the violence suggests young, healthy assailants, a suggestion supported by surveillance footage taken from the killing.

Internal Examination,



Police Initial Investigations,

Fucking nonsense. We shouldn't have brought these frat kids.

Maryland State Police have already investigated the murder weapons and eliminated their owner as a suspect. The tools used to kill Kerry Houghton have labels on the handles, written in permanent marker. They belong to one Kim Sun-Hu and bear his phone number. Sun-Hu works maintenance for the prison and has a rock-solid alibi for Thursday night and Friday morning, The Cecil County pulled two sets of prints off the murder weapons. Cross referencing all available databases returned a single match: Elle Gable, a 19-year-old with no criminal record. Gable's prints were in a National Child Identification Program database.